

Power Query Editor Tour

30-Minute Hands-On Review | Week 9, Section 3B

Learning Objectives: Navigate to the Power Query Editor from the Power BI Desktop interface | Identify and describe the five panes and areas of the Power Query Editor | Classify a data source into its correct category | Apply knowledge of the interface to locate the right pane or tool for a real analyst task

Instructions: Complete all four parts in 30 minutes. Refer to your Section 3B notes. Be ready to discuss your answers with the class.

Part 1: Fill in the Blank (~7 minutes)

Complete each sentence with the correct term or phrase from Section 3B.

1.	To open the Power Query Editor from Power BI Desktop, click _____ in the Data or Queries section of the Home ribbon.
2.	To connect to a new data source without opening the Power Query Editor, use the _____ button on the Home ribbon.
3.	The _____ displays all queries already in your project and allows you to organize them into folders.
4.	The list of all steps that make up a query, where steps can be reordered, removed, or edited via a gear icon, is found in the _____.
5.	The _____ shows the M code behind the currently selected step and can be expanded to multiple lines for easier editing.
6.	The central workspace of the Power Query Editor displays a live preview of the data after the selected step has been applied; this area is called the _____.

Part 2: Matching (~6 minutes)

Write the letter of the correct description next to each Power Query Editor pane or element.

Pane / Element	Description
A. Ribbon Pane	1. Entry point to connect Power BI to any supported external data source
B. Queries List Pane	2. Displays all queries in the project; supports folder organization for large projects

C. Query Settings Pane	3. Lists the Applied Steps for the selected query; allows reordering, deletion, and gear-icon editing
D. Body Region	4. Live preview of transformed data; supports right-click menus, double-click to rename, and drag to reorder columns
E. Expression Editor	5. Contains contextual shortcuts for bringing in data and applying common transformations
F. Get Data	6. Shows the M expression for the selected step; expandable for complex edits

Part 3: Classify the Data Source (~8 minutes)

Power Query supports six categories of data sources. For each source listed below, write the correct category in the right column. Choose from: Databases | Files | Web | Microsoft Fabric and Azure | Online Services (SaaS) | Power Platform

#	Data Source	Source Category
1	A folder of monthly sales CSV files stored on SharePoint	
2	A PostgreSQL database hosted on-premises at company headquarters	
3	Salesforce CRM customer and opportunity records	
4	A live OData feed from a government statistics website	
5	An Excel workbook saved in OneDrive	
6	A MySQL database accessible via the cloud	
7	An Azure Data Lake Storage (Blob Storage) container	
8	Google Analytics website traffic data	
9	A public URL that returns product pricing as a web page table	
10	A Dataverse environment from Microsoft Power Apps	
11	A Lakehouse in Microsoft Fabric	
12	A JSON file exported from an internal API and saved locally	

Hint: Review Section 3B.2. The six categories are: Databases | Files | Web | Microsoft Fabric and Azure | Online Services (SaaS) | Power Platform

Part 4: Short Answer (~9 minutes)

Answer each question in 2-4 sentences in your own words.

Question 1

An analyst opens Power BI Desktop and wants to connect to a new SQL Server database. Which ribbon button do they click, and what happens next? Walk through the steps to launch Power Query Editor with data loaded.

Question 2

After applying ten transformation steps to a query, the analyst realizes that Step 4 produced an incorrect result. Which pane allows them to navigate back to Step 4 to inspect and fix it? Describe two actions they can take on that step using that pane.

Question 3

A project has grown to include 25 queries connecting to four different data sources. The team is having trouble finding specific queries quickly. What feature of the Power Query Editor helps organize large numbers of queries, and where is it found?

Question 4

An analyst is reviewing a step in the Query Settings Pane and wants to understand the exact M code that Power Query wrote for that step. They also want to make a small edit the GUI cannot handle. Which pane shows the code, and how can they expand it for easier editing?

Bonus / Reflection (if time allows)

The Power Query Editor body region lets you right-click columns, double-click to rename, and drag to reorder -- all without using the ribbon. In 3-5 sentences, explain why having these context-sensitive actions directly on the data preview is useful for a data analyst. How does this compare to how you would do the same tasks in Excel or SQL?
